

Bank of England

Academic Consultant Agreement

THIS AGREEMENT is made the 15th day of September 2026.

BETWEEN:

1. **THE BANK OF ENGLAND**, whose principal place of business is at Threadneedle Street, London, EC2R 8AH (the "**Bank**"); and
2. **JUAN RUBIO-RAMIREZ**, whose principal place of business is at Emory University, Atlanta, USA. For the purposes of this Agreement, the Academic Consultant will provide the Services remotely from Barcelona, Spain (the "**Academic Consultant**").

WHEREAS

The Bank wishes to avail itself of the Services of the Academic Consultant, who has agreed to make such Services available in their individual capacity with effect from 15 September 2026 (the "**Commencement Date**") upon the terms and subject to the conditions of this agreement (the "**Agreement**") and subject at all times to satisfactory security clearance of the Academic Consultant in the opinion of the Bank.

IT IS AGREED as follows:

1. Services

- 1.1 In this Agreement, "**Services**" shall mean carrying out academic research for the Bank and to engage in collaborative knowledge-sharing with Bank employees as described in Appendix A (the "**Project**"), working with the Global Analysis Division of the Bank.
- 1.2 The Academic Consultant agrees to make their Services available to the Bank from the Commencement Date until 28 February 2027, unless terminated earlier pursuant to clause 5 or extended by mutual agreement and in writing. In this Agreement, the "**Term**" shall mean the period between the Commencement Date and the date on which this Agreement terminates (howsoever caused).
- 1.3 During the engagement the Academic Consultant shall, unless prevented by ill health or accident, devote 8 days during the Term carrying out the services together with such additional time, if any, as may be necessary to ensure compliance with applicable deadlines in respect of the Project and to ensure that any Project deliverables shall be fit for any purpose expressly or implicitly made known to the Academic Consultant by the Bank.
- 1.4 During the Term, the Academic Consultant will be reporting principally to Ambrogio Cesa-Bianchi. Where practicable, the Academic Consultant may conduct the Services at such times and locations of the Academic Consultant's choosing, subject to compliance with the Bank's policies and procedures (see clause 4.5).

- 1.5 The Bank agrees that the Academic Consultant's engagement with the Bank is a non-exclusive arrangement, and therefore that the Academic Consultant may be engaged, employed, or concerned in any other trade, profession or activity during the Term.

2. Substitution

- 2.1 The Academic Consultant may appoint a suitably qualified and skilled substitute to perform the Services on their behalf (the "Substitute"), provided that prior to the Substitute commencing work on the Services:

2.1.1 written approval is obtained from the Bank;

2.1.2 the Substitute is approved via the Bank's security vetting process; and

2.1.3 the Substitute enters into direct undertakings with the Bank, including with regard to confidentiality.

- 2.2 If the Bank accepts the Substitute, the Academic Consultant shall continue to invoice the Bank in accordance with clause 3 and shall be responsible for the remuneration of the Substitute. For the avoidance of doubt, the Academic Consultant will continue to be subject to all duties and obligations under this Agreement for the duration of the appointment of the Substitute.

3. Fees

The Bank will pay the Academic Consultant an amount of £500 per day for a maximum of 8 days during the Term (exclusive of VAT). Each day shall be calculated on the basis of seven (7) working hours. The Academic Consultant shall submit invoices to the Bank on a monthly basis setting out the hours that they have worked for the Bank during the preceding calendar month and any VAT payable (if applicable). The Bank will pay any undisputed invoices within 30 days of receipt. Any change in fees shall be agreed in writing between the parties.that they have worked for the Bank during the preceding calendar month and any VAT payable (if applicable). The Bank will pay any undisputed invoices within 30 days of receipt. Any change in fees shall be agreed in writing between the parties.

4. Status of the Academic Consultant

- 4.1 The Agreement constitutes a contract for the provision of services and is not a contract of employment. Accordingly, the Academic Consultant shall not at any time during the Term be an employee or worker of, or be maintained on the payroll of, the Bank.
- 4.2 The Academic Consultant shall be responsible for all taxes, National Insurance contributions and other liabilities and charges incurred for which they are liable, including all such taxes and liabilities on the fees as set out in clause 3. The Academic Consultant will indemnify the Bank in respect of any claims or demands made by relevant authorities against the Bank in respect of the services performed by them in connection with the Agreement. The Academic Consultant shall be fully

responsible for and indemnify the Bank against any liability, assessment or claim for any employment-related claim or any claim based on worker status (including reasonable costs and expenses) brought by them against the Bank arising out of or in connection with the provision of the services under the Agreement. The Bank may satisfy such indemnity (in whole or in part) by way of deduction from any payment due to the Academic Consultant.

- 4.3 The Academic Consultant shall, for the duration of the Term, perform their duties with the professional skill and standard reasonably expected of someone of the Academic Consultant's qualification and experience. However, the Academic Consultant shall have no authority to exercise any functions of, act on behalf of, or make any statements on behalf of the Bank. Further, the Academic Consultant shall have no right or authority to bind the Bank in any way in relation to third parties, save as specifically authorised by the Bank from time to time.
- 4.4 The Academic Consultant warrants that they hold the requisite immigration permissions and qualifications to provide the Services in the UK and any other relevant location. The Academic Consultant shall be responsible for obtaining any required work permit or visa to allow them to work within the United Kingdom and to provide the Services and indemnifies the Bank in respect of any costs, claims, damages or other losses incurred by the Bank as a result of the Academic Consultant's failure to obtain such a work permit or visa.
- 4.5 Although the Academic Consultant shall not be an employee or worker of the Bank, the Academic Consultant shall in the provision of the Services comply with the Bank's general requirements of its own employees concerning conduct and all Bank policies and procedures, as in force from time to time, which shall include (but not be limited to) the requirements contained under Data Protection Legislation (as defined in clause 9.2). In addition, the Academic Consultant shall be bound by the Contractors' Code of Practice and the confidentiality obligations contained in the Declaration of Secrecy for Non-Bank Staff.
- 4.6 The Academic Consultant shall not, without the prior written consent of the Bank, advertise or publicly announce the nature, existence or content of this Agreement. This provision shall remain in force notwithstanding termination of this Agreement.

5. Termination

- 5.1 This Agreement shall be terminated:
 - 5.1.1 automatically and without the need for notice, upon the Academic Consultant no longer meeting the security clearance requirements of the Bank and/or no longer holding the requisite immigration permissions and qualifications to provide the Services;
 - 5.1.2 at the discretion of the Bank, and immediately on delivery of written notice to such effect by the Bank to the Academic Consultant, if:

- i. the Academic Consultant is guilty of any serious misconduct, or any conduct which affects or is likely to affect prejudicially the interests of the Bank;
 - ii. the Academic Consultant is unable to perform the Services by reason of ill-health, accident, or otherwise, for a period aggregating at least 20 working days and a Substitute has not been engaged (including having passed the Bank security vetting process) in accordance with Clause 2;
 - iii. the Academic Consultant is in persistent breach of any of the terms of this Agreement;
 - iv. the Academic Consultant wilfully neglects or refuses to carry out any of the Services or to comply with any reasonable instruction given to them by the Bank;
 - v. the Academic Consultant is charged with or convicted of any offence;
- 5.1.3 by either party, at their discretion on two weeks' prior written notice to the other party;
- 5.1.4 Automatically in accordance with clause 1.2.
- 5.2 On termination of this Agreement, howsoever caused, the Academic Consultant shall immediately deliver up to the Bank all Bank property (including but not limited to documents of whatsoever nature) compiled or acquired by them during this Agreement and relating to or, or its clients, customers or suppliers, supervised firms and other stakeholders which is in the possession of, or under the control of, the Academic Consultant.
- 5.3 Termination of this Agreement, howsoever caused, shall not affect the provisions of clause 7 (Confidentiality), clause 8 (Intellectual Property Rights) or clause 9 (Data Protection).
- 6. Restrictive Covenant**

The Academic Consultant undertakes that during the Term, and for the period of six months immediately following the termination of this Agreement, it will not directly or indirectly induce or encourage any employee of the Bank (with whom the Academic Consultant has had dealings in the Bank at any time during the Term) to leave the employment of the Bank. The Academic Consultant acknowledges that the provisions of this clause are fair, reasonable and necessary to protect the goodwill and interests of the Bank.
- 7. Confidentiality**
 - 7.1 The Academic Consultant may have access to the Bank's confidential information, which includes all information (whether written, oral or by another means and

whether directly or indirectly) relating to the Bank (whether or not acting in its capacity as the Prudential Regulation Authority (the “**PRA**”)) and whether created before, on or after the date of this Agreement, and whether created or received by or on behalf of the Bank or the PRA, including in each case and without limitation: (i) information relating to the Bank’s (including the Bank acting in its capacity as the PRA) intellectual property rights, trade secrets, software, products, systems, operations, processes, plans or intentions, product information, know-how and market opportunities; (ii) information relating to the Bank’s (including the Bank acting in its capacity as the PRA) business, identity and affairs and the business, identity and affairs of its directors, officers, employees, suppliers, agents, regulated firms or sub-contractors and the like, which comes into the Academic Consultant’s possession and any market sensitive information; (iii) information relating to the business or other affairs of any person which was received by the Bank or the PRA in the course of its functions directly or indirectly (for example, through another competent authority) and which is not otherwise publicly available; and (iv) “personal data” within the meaning of the Data Protection Legislation (in each case, “**Confidential Information**”).

- 7.2 Some of the Confidential Information may constitute “confidential information” within the meaning of section 348 of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 as amended from time to time (“**FSMA**”, and such “confidential information”, “**FSMA Confidential Information**”) or “restricted information” within the meaning of section 17(1) or paragraph 9 of Schedule 2 of the Bank of England Act 1998 as amended from time to time (the “**BoE Act**”, and such “restricted information”, “**BoE Act Restricted Information**”). The Academic Consultant must ensure that they are aware that disclosing FSMA Confidential Information in breach of section 348 FSMA is a criminal offence in the UK and that disclosing BoE Act Restricted Information in breach of Schedule 7 of the BoE Act is also a criminal offence. Each such offence carries a maximum sentence of two years’ imprisonment.
- 7.3 Some of the Confidential Information may constitute “confidential information” within the meaning of the common law duty of confidentiality that the Academic Consultant may owe to the Bank or the PRA; and some of the Confidential Information may constitute a “trade secret” within the meaning of regulation 2 of the Trade Secrets (Enforcement, etc.) Regulations 2018.
- 7.4 When the Academic Consultant is in receipt of any Confidential Information, the Bank (whether or not acting in its capacity as the PRA) will make such Confidential Information (including FSMA Confidential Information and BoE Act Restricted Information) available to the Academic Consultant on the following terms and conditions (the “**Confidentiality Obligations**”):
- a) **The Bank will**, during the Term, provide the Confidential Information to the Academic Consultant in hard copy which may only be accessed and reviewed whilst on Bank’s premises or electronic format, which may only be accessed and reviewed via the laptop provided to the Academic Consultant by the Bank. On termination of the Project or this Agreement (whichever comes first) the Academic Consultant will return any Bank laptop to the Bank.

- b) **The Academic Consultant will not** directly or indirectly disclose any Confidential Information, whether in whole or in part, to any person without the prior written consent of the Bank.
- c) **The Academic Consultant may** use the Confidential Information to assist with the Project, where relevant, but may not copy, quote, summarise or otherwise disclose such Confidential Information.
- d) **The Academic Consultant will not** use or exploit the Confidential Information for any purpose other than for the completion of the Project.
- e) **The Academic Consultant will not** copy, reduce to writing, electronically store, or otherwise record any Confidential Information, or send any Confidential Information to any system other than the Bank's internal IT system, nor will the Academic Consultant remove any documents (whether paper or electronic) from the Bank's premises.
- f) **The Academic Consultant will** return or, where applicable, destroy or delete any Confidential Information in their possession at the end of the Term.
- g) **The Academic Consultant will** abide by any Data Handling Guidelines as provided to them from time to time by the Bank.
- h) **The Academic Consultant will** sign and abide by the Bank's Declaration of Secrecy for Non-Bank Academic Consultants and Regular Visitors.

7.5 The Confidentiality Obligations will not apply to the extent that the use or disclosure of Confidential Information is a requirement of law placed upon the Academic Consultant and (in the case of FSMA Confidential Information and BoE Act Restricted Information only) the Academic Consultant is permitted to use or disclose such information at law. If the Academic Consultant is required to use or disclose all or part of the Confidential Information pursuant to any legal requirement the Academic Consultant shall notify the Bank immediately upon becoming aware that such use or disclosure is required, and to the extent the Academic Consultant is legally permitted to do so, advise the Bank of the circumstances in which the use or disclosure is required.

8. Intellectual Property Rights

All existing intellectual property rights in any material belonging to a party prior to the Commencement Date shall remain the property of that party. The Academic Consultant confirms that their work on the Project will not infringe or violate the rights (including intellectual property rights) of any third party. Any new intellectual property (including without limitation rights in patents, copyright, registered design right, design right, trademarks, confidential information and know how) which arise by virtue of the activities of the Academic Consultant during the provision of the Services shall belong to the Bank absolutely. The Academic Consultant shall, at the request and expense of the Bank, execute such documents and do such things as may be required to vest such rights in the Bank with full title guarantee or provide evidence of such vesting as the case may be. The Academic Consultant agrees to waive, in respect of any work done by them as part of the Project, and any updates or revisions to such work, all moral rights which the Academic Consultant may have or at any time be entitled to under the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 as

amended from time to time and under all other relevant legislation from time to time in force anywhere in the world.

9. Data Protection

- 9.1 The Academic Consultant confirms that they acknowledge that the Bank will process their personal data (which may include sensitive personal data) in accordance with its data protection policies and Data Protection Legislation. The Academic Consultant agrees to comply with data protection laws, and any rules, policies and procedures of the Bank relating to data protection in force from time to time.
- 9.2. For the purposes of this Agreement, “**Data Protection Legislation**” means the UK GDPR, the Data Protection Act 2018, (and regulations made thereunder), the Privacy and Electronic Communications Regulations 2003 (SI 2003/2426) as amended, and all applicable laws and regulations relating to processing of personal data and privacy, including where applicable the guidance and codes of practice issued by the Information Commissioner.

10 General

- 10.1 No term in this Agreement is enforceable under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 by a person who is not a party to this Agreement.
- 10.2 This Agreement is governed by and shall be construed in accordance with the laws of England and the parties to this Agreement hereby submit to the non-exclusive jurisdiction of the English courts.
- 10.3 This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties and supersedes and extinguishes all previous agreements, promises, assurances, warranties, representations and understandings between them, whether written or oral.
- 10.4 No variation of this Agreement shall be effective unless it is in writing and signed by the parties

Please sign and return the counterpart copy of this Agreement to indicate your acceptance of the terms and conditions set out in this Agreement.

Signed by

MATTHEW TROTT

for and on behalf of the Bank

Dated

Signed by

JUAN RUBIO-RAMIREZ

for and on behalf of the Academic Consultant

Dated

Appendix A

Services

As the expert on the development of new econometric techniques that allow for the estimation of multi-country VAR models, Prof Rubio-Ramirez will collaborate with us on the use of these techniques to inform our policy work and international engagement. This will allow us to undertake richer, more sophisticated, and empirically congruent analysis of spillovers to the UK of developments in the rest of the world, both from a macroeconomic and a financial perspective.

The consultancy will deliver a vector autoregressive (VAR) model, namely a multi-country empirical model that allows us to assess the international transmission of shocks. The model will help analyse how economic shocks and policy actions are transmitted across borders, which is an important aspect of understanding the UK economy. The model will be built in MATLAB and estimated using data for the euro area, the US, China, and the UK.